



INFRASTRUCTURE

VARIABLES: Percentage of households with electricity, percentage of villages connected with pucca roads (surfaced + unsurfaced), road length/total households, no. of post offices/population, tele-connectivity.

BIG STATES

RANK 2008		2008*	2007	2006	2005	2004
1	PUNJAB	5.72	1	1	1	1
2	HIMACHAL PRADESH	5.15	2	2	2	2
3	KERALA	5.10	3	3	6	7
4	TAMIL NADU	4.84	7	5	9	8
5	MAHARASHTRA	4.47	6	4	3	3
6	KARNATAKA	4.28	8	7	10	9
7	HARYANA	4.20	4	6	4	6
8	GUJARAT	4.18	9	9	7	5
9	ANDHRA PRADESH	3.84	10	10	11	11
10	JAMMU & KASHMIR	3.55	11	11	8	10
11	UTTARAKHAND	3.33	5	8	5	4
12	RAJASTHAN	3.23	13	13	12	12
13	MADHYA PRADESH	3.04	12	12	13	13
14	WEST BENGAL	2.88	15	15	14	14
15	UTTAR PRADESH	2.48	18	18	16	17
16	ORISSA	2.47	16	16	18	18
17	ASSAM	2.37	17	17	15	15
18	CHHATTISGARH	1.95	14	14	17	16
19	BIHAR	1.89	20	20	20	20
20	JHARKHAND	1.64	19	19	19	19

SMALL STATES

1	DELHI	9.18	1	1	1	1
2	GOA	4.28	2	2	2	2
3	PUDUCHERRY	2.97	3	3	3	3
4	MIZORAM	2.84	4	4	4	4
5	SIKKIM	2.76	5	5	5	5
6	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	2.43	6	6	6	6
7	MANIPUR	2.16	7	7	7	7
8	NAGALAND	2.08	9	8	8	9
9	MEGHALAYA	1.77	10	10	10	10
10	TRIPURA	1.75	8	9	9	8

UNION TERRITORIES

1	CHANDIGARH	4.32	1	1	1	1
2	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	3.53	4	4	4	4
3	DAMAN & DIU	2.96	3	3	2	2
4	LAKSHADWEEP	2.68	2	2	3	3
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	2.50	5	5	5	5

Rank went down Constant rank Rank went up Fastest Mover

2 HIMACHAL PRADESH Sustained Reforms Deliver

• Best in Investment, Education and Health

ANIL DAYAL



GETTING IT RIGHT:
Dhuma focuses on
public service

When it comes to getting development priorities right, Himachal Pradesh is the best lesson for other states. This land-locked hill state's trail-blazing record in road connectivity and social sectors like education and health exemplify what a focussed policy prescription backed by political commitment and a resource back-up can achieve. In the first three decades of its formation, Himachal was guided by the "roads-bring-wealth" mantra. In the mid-'80s, it focussed on its vast hydel power potential. By the end of the Seventh Plan, it bolstered school infrastructure by spending 45 per cent of its budget on education. The result was an incredible schooling revolution making Himachal the first state to achieve universalisation of primary education and 100 per cent literacy—faster than Kerala. This, in turn, has

45 per cent
of the state's budget is
spent on education

- The state is the first to achieve 100 per cent literacy
- Tourism is a growing industry here



**PUNJAB IS THE
FASTEST MOVER**

The emergence of private mandis, arrival of retail and realisation of the need to improve income levels propel both Akalis and the Congress to invest in improving connectivity.